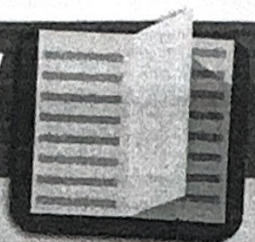


ACADEMIC DICTIONARY



IMPROVING VOCABULARY IN FORMAL WRITING

As you embark on the journey of academic writing, one crucial aspect that can significantly enhance the impact of your writing is the careful selection of words. Your word choices shape the tone, clarity, and sophistication of your writing. This handout is designed to help you improve your formal writing by replacing common weak word choices with stronger, more precise language.

INFORMAL VERBS

- Use
- Show
- Make
- Get
- Put
- Think
- Find
- Tell
- Do
- Have
- Say
- Go
- Ask
- Know
- Believe
- Like
- Take
- Give
- Use
- See
- Tell
- Said
- Seem
- Feel

FORMAL VERBS

- Advocates
- Alludes
- Argues
- Asserts
- Clarifies
- Compares
- Conveys
- Contrasts
- Creates
- Expresses
- Depicts
- Describes
- Defines
- Demonstrates
- Develops
- Emphasizes
- Establishes
- Examines
- Explores
- Implements
- Inquire
- Introduces
- Juxtaposes
- Portrays
- Presents
- Proceed
- Proves
- Reveals
- Tackles
- Transforms
- Upholds
- Validates

INFORMAL ADJECTIVES OR ADVERBS

- Good
- Bad
- Nice
- Big
- Small
- Interesting
- Important
- Beautiful
- Fun
- Very
- Really
- So
- Well
- Quite
- Almost
- Always
- Never
- Just
- Totally
- Old
- New
- Easy
- Fast
- Slow

FORMAL ADJECTIVES OR ADVERBS

- Excellent
- Detrimental
- Pleasant
- Substantial
- Minute
- Fascinating
- Crucial
- Exquisite
- Enthralling
- Challenging
- Significant
- Valuable
- Valid
- Unbiased
- Plausible
- Beneficial
- Remarkably
- Truly
- Exceedingly
- Efficiently
- Considerably
- Nearly
- Consistently
- Rarely
- Precisely
- Completely
- Thoroughly
- Creatively
- Mildly
- Vividly
- Frequently
- Seldom

OTHER WORDS TO AVOID

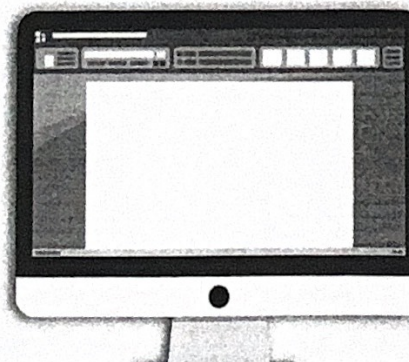
- Lots
- A lot
- Well
- Fine
- So
- Fun
- Kind of
- Sort of
- Personally
- I think
- Maybe
- Perhaps
- Thing
- I believe
- It seems to me

ALTERNATIVE STRONGER CHOICES

- Numerous
- Considerable
- Effectively
- Satisfactory
- Therefore
- Entertaining
- To some extent
- To a degree
- It is arguable that
- It is evident that
- Conceivably
- Possibly
- Aspect
- It is apparent that
- It appears

ONE MORE FORMAL WRITING TIP...

Consider consulting a thesaurus during your writing process. While you need not look up every word for a replacement, focus on **key terms** that could benefit from a more formal tone. Explore alternative word choices to enhance the overall formality and precision of your writing.



quite & a bit!

Learn 8 for each box